

Dear Final-Year Students,

As you enter the final stretch of your master's programme, which you started in September 2024, it is crucial to start preparing for your final exam. The sooner you begin, the more confident and prepared you will feel. Allow me to share some details of the closing examination process to guide you in this critical task.

1. Final exams will be organised right at the end of the exam period, which is one week shorter for you than what you are used to. Plan your exams for the current semester wisely so you have all your marks by the deadline.
2. The Final Exam comprehensively assesses your knowledge and skills. It consists of two parts: the Complex Exam and the Thesis Defence. The complex exam, which covers all the core finance subjects of the program, is divided into a written and an oral part. The Thesis Defence involves **presenting your written thesis** and **answering questions from the exam committee**. The oral parts of the complex exam and the thesis defence are held on the same day, in front of the same committee, one after the other.
3. It is crucial to remember that to be eligible for the Final Exam, you must ensure all your grades are recorded in the Neptun system. It's your responsibility to double-check well in advance whether you have fulfilled all the requirements of the master's program, including mandatory subjects, obligatory electives, elective courses, and the total number of credits. Please note that planning ordinary exams after the application deadline is not allowed.
4. The Complex Exam consists of two parts. First, there is a **written part**, where you must achieve **a minimum score (15 out of 25)** to receive a passing grade in the oral part. Once you reach that level, the number of points you have gained no longer matters. You can only sit for the written Complex Exam once a semester. Thus, a resit can only happen six months later at the end of the next exam period. Be very careful, as under Hungarian law, you can not sit for your complex exam more than 3 times.
5. The two reviewers will provide you with the grades for your thesis approximately a week before the final exam. A third reviewer will assess your paper if there is a significant difference of more than two grades between their evaluations. Only the two highest grades will be considered for your final results. It is important to note that you will automatically fail if one of the reviewers detects plagiarism in your paper. Plagiarism is defined as any text or idea (!) that lacks proper attribution and is not original. If both initial reviewers deem the paper a no-pass, you must write a new paper and submit it no earlier than six months later.
6. At the **oral part** of the Complex Exam, you will be given **two randomly selected topics**. (Usually, we ask you for a blind pick from an envelope.) The topics would cover **general knowledge of finance**, including **all core finance subjects** (**Investments, Banking, Risk Management and Financial Institutions, International Corporate Finance, Applied Business Valuation**) and **any knowledge required for your entrance exam**. Kindly consult the list of topics attached.

7. All topics require a general understanding of multiple subjects. The best technique is to prepare a 2-3-page written review for each topic after scanning all the notes and books you used to study finance. Do not rely on AI outputs, as those may contain false or incomplete information. Memorising that review will help you deliver a complex yet concise topic presentation and effectively answer committee questions during your oral exam. You may not use written notes there, but you will have some minutes to prepare.

8. To receive a passing grade, you must reach the minimum level for both of your topics during the oral. You cannot choose another topic if you do not like what you got for your first trial.

9. Once the oral part of the Complex Exam is over, regardless of its result, you may go on to the oral part of the Thesis Defence. Thus, you can have a successful Thesis Defence exam even if you need to resit for the Complex Exam or vice versa.

10. The dress code for the oral closing exam is Business Formal (dark suit, white shirt, and tie). In this conservative profession, elegance creates trust.

11. For further details, please consult the Exam Regulations of the university.

Good luck to all of you.

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Final Exam Question Set

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| 1. | Capital structure (optimum, effects on risk and value, MM theorem) | |
| 2. | Cost of capital (pricing risk, CAPM, effect of leverage, estimating required rates) | International Corporate Finance |
| 3. | Working capital management and short-term financing (international cash management, sources of short-term financing, trade credit, receivables, payables, inventory, cash management) | |
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| 4. | DCF valuation methods (types of cash flows, cash flow matching, calculating terminal value) | Applied Business Valuation |
| 5. | Non-CF-based valuation methods (selecting peers, types of multiples, asset-based valuation approaches) | |
| 6. | Valuation challenges of M&As (getting the price range, types of synergy, discounts and premiums) | |
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| 7. | Bond valuation and trading (types, risk types, measuring interest rate risk, embedded options, trading conventions) | Investment |
| 8. | Derivatives I: Futures, forwards, swaps (definition, types, pricing, trading) | |
| 9. | Derivatives II: Options and the Greeks (definition, types, moneyness, payoff and gain functions, pricing, risk types) | |
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| 10. | Banking regulation and supervision (macro-prudential and micro-prudential regulations, Basel I, II, III, FED, ECB) | Banking |
| 11. | Deposits and payment services (role of deposits in banks' BS and P&L, types of deposits, history of payment services, SEPA, PSD2, FinTech innovations, deposit insurance) | |
| 12. | Retail & wholesale loans (types and differences between retail and wholesale loans, rating, scoring, structured and project financing, collaterals and covenants) | |
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| 13. | Credit risk management and regulation (estimating default probabilities, credit value at risk, counterparty credit risk, and regulatory requirements) | |
| 14. | Market risk management and regulation (risk measurement, properties of risk measures, risk measurement of stocks, bonds, derivatives and portfolios, capital requirements for credit risk, FRTB) | Risk Management and Financial Institutions |
| 15. | Operational risk management and regulation (definition, types, BIA, ASTA, AMA, SMA, modelling operational losses, regulatory requirements, crisis risk) | |

Any Knowledge required for the Entrance Exam:

VBA

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Math

Investment